

A single adaptive engine precisely scales every session — push, pull, lower, core, sets, reps, rest — from a first workout to field-ready performance.

THE THREE-TIER SYSTEM

FOUNDATIONHIGH SCHOOL · NOVICE

20–30 minSESSION

2→3 setsPER EXERCISE

5–9 /wkSETS/MUSCLE

Total-body sessions

8–12 reps

60–90 sec rest

Form before load

NSCA & AAP backed

CHALLENGERACTIVE ADULT · INTERMEDIATE

35–50 minSESSION

3 setsPER EXERCISE

10–15 /wkSETS/MUSCLE

Push / Pull / Legs split

Antagonist supersets

Monthly A/B periodization

4–15 reps (schedule-dependent)

VETERANMILITARY · ATHLETE · ADVANCED

50–60 minSESSION

4 setsPER EXERCISE

15–20 /wkSETS/MUSCLE

AFT-aligned (Army 2025)

Concurrent training

4-week mesocycle

Deload week built in

3–5 strength protocol

GRADUAL TRANSITIONS — NO CLIFF EDGES

L1–7FOUNDATION

L8–12BLEND

L13–21CHALLENGER

L22–28BLEND

L29+VETERAN

Exercises scale underneath the user — sprint squat replaces squat hold, diamond push-up emerges, density protocols unlock.

MUSCLE GROUP	FOUNDATION	CHALLENGER	VETERAN
Upper Push	6–9	10–15	15–20
Upper Pull	6–9	8–12	12–18
Lower Body	6–9	10–15	15–18
Core	6–9	10–15	15–20

SESSION ARCHITECTURE

1WARMUP

Dynamic movement — inchworm, hip circles, arm swings. Activates posterior chain and shoulders.

5 min

2FOUNDATION BLOCK

Every muscle pattern, every session — regardless of tier. Non-negotiable.

PUSH

PULL

LOWER

CORE

Scales by tier

3SPECIALIZATION SLOT

Chosen each session. Shapes personal workout trajectory and focus over time.

STRENGTH

CONDITIONING

FLEXIBILITY

RECOVERY

10–15 min

4COOLDOWN

Static stretches — 30–60 sec holds. Post-workout only. Pre-workout static stretch reduces force output. (Huberman Ep. 94)

5 min

3 + 1 WEEKLY RHYTHM

MONWorkout

TUERecovery

WEDWorkout

THURecovery

FRIWorkout

SATZone 2 Alt

SUNRest

3–4×/week is the empirically optimal habit-formation frequency (Kaushal & Rhodes 2015). 50% of gym members drop out before week 6 — short, consistent sessions outperform long, infrequent ones at every fitness level.

MONTHLY PERIODIZATION

MONTH AStrength

4–8 reps · 3–4 sets
2–4 min rest between sets
Neural adaptation

↔

MONTH BHypertrophy

8–15 reps · 2–3 sets
~90 sec rest between sets
Structural adaptation

Alternating monthly captures both neural strength gains and structural hypertrophy gains. Neither alone is optimal. — Huberman Foundational Protocol [verified]

ADAPTIVE INTAKE

5

movement calibrations at session one — push, pull, lower, core, and cardio endurance

Live

performance data — not self-reported level — determines starting prescription

Auto

adjusts every session: "too hard" reduces volume; "too easy" scales prescription up

No buckets. No drop-down menus. Continuous placement from the first rep.

RESEARCH FOUNDATION

50%

of gym members drop out before week 6. The 3-day structure is the evidence-based response — habit formation peaks at 3–4×/week in the critical first 6 weeks.

+0.37%

additional muscle growth per additional weekly set above minimum volume. Every set is accounted for and prescribed precisely. (Schoenfeld 2017)

Schoenfeld 2017

Journal of Sports Sciences, 35(11), 1073–1082

≤4 setsSubstantial gains — viable for time-constrained users

5–9 sets~80% of maximum hypertrophic gains (Foundation tier)

10–15 setsMaximizes hypertrophy (Challenger tier)

15–20 setsWell-trained optimum per Galpin (Veteran tier)

Huberman Lab — Foundational Protocol

Newsletter + Podcast Ep. 94 "Fitness Toolkit"

5–15 setsPer muscle per week, 30–80% 1RM — most scientifically supported

A / BMonthly periodization: strength ↔ hypertrophy alternating

Zone 2180–200 min/week target; 4th optional day builds this base

NSCA (2009) · AAP (2020) · Army AFT (2025)

Youth RT Position Stand · Pediatrics · Army Directive 2025-06

2–3×/wkNon-consecutive days — NSCA Youth RT standard (Foundation)

Form firstNeural gains dominate in novice — load is secondary to technique

AFT eventsDeadlift · Push-up · Sprint-Drag-Carry · Plank · 2-Mile Run — Veteran tier sessions address all five

Research basis: Schoenfeld BJ et al. (2017). J Sports Sci 35(11):1073–1082. · Huberman Lab Newsletter: Foundational Fitness Protocol; Podcast Ep. 94. · NSCA Position Stand: Youth Resistance Training (2009). J Strength Cond Res 23(Suppl). · AAP Clinical Report: Resistance Training for Children and Adolescents (2020). Pediatrics. · Army Directive 2025-06: Army Fitness Test (AFT), effective June 1 2025. · Kaushal N & Rhodes RE (2015). Habit formation and physical activity. Psychol Sport Exerc 16:17–24. · Galpin AJ / Huberman Lab: Building Strength and Power (transcript verified). · SDT 2025 study (n=60): autonomy-supported PE, intrinsic motivation +99%, MVPA +64%. (Carried from prior synthesis session — primary paper pending independent verification.)

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